be met entirely by exposure to sunlight. In the absence of exposure to sunlight a daily intake of 400 IU vitamin D is suggested. Vitamin D is produced under the skin after exposure to ultraviolet rays. Vitamin D is now considered as a pro hormone rather than a vitamin and is required for Calcium absorption and bone formation.

DO YOU KNOW...?

Vitamin D:

D_2 (ergocalciferol) and D_3 (cholecalciferol)

Functions

- It helps in the formation of bones and teeth.
- It also improves the calcification of bones.
- It helps to increase the absorption of calcium and phosphorus.
- It helps in increase of calcium content in bones and blood.

Sources of Vitamin D:

Sunlight: Exposure of skin to sunlight brings about synthesis of vitamin D from 7 dehydrocholesterol.

Food sources: Cod liver oil, liver, salmon and herring fish, fortified milk, egg yolk, butter, cheese, ghee, cream, fortified milk, etc., are the best sources of Vitamin D.

Vitamin D deficiency:

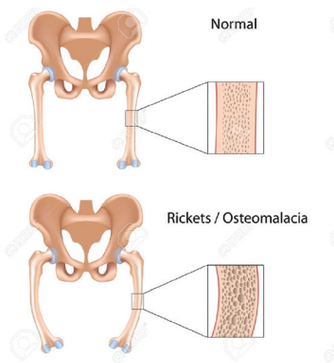
Deficiency in children

Rickets:

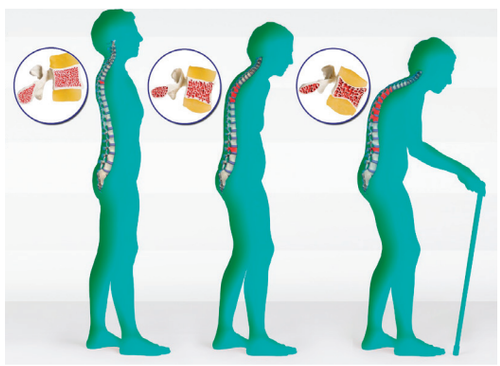
When children don't get enough vitamin D, they cannot absorb enough calcium and phosphorus to mineralize and harden the



A child with Rickets



Osteomalacia



Osteoporosis

Fig 11.3: Symptoms of Vitamin D

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